

【8.22| Economist】 Under a cloud 烟云之下

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

【考研那些事儿之环境系列】

今日文章脉络:

2015 年印尼火灾导致大量毒烟，
引起东南亚地区众怒 (Para. 1)



今年 8 月，印尼山火再度频发，
浓烟笼罩多地 (Para. 2)



厄尔尼诺现象或许增加了印尼火灾的概率 (Para. 3)



2015 年的火灾导致大量生命和财产损失 (Para. 4)



伊朗局势还可能会加重此次灾情 (Para. 5)



不过，相较之下，东南亚各国此次应对方案更为完备 (Para. 6)



但这些方案在落地上仍有所欠缺 (Para. 7)



印尼国内政局的变动也会牵动此次烟霾问题 (Para. 8)

South-East Asia **braces** for more smoke from Indonesia

东南亚紧急应对印尼愈发频发的浓烟

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

In 2015, as South-East Asia was **engulfed** in toxic smog caused by fires in Indonesia, Jusuf Kalla, the country's vice-president at the time, suggested that his neighbours needed a change in perspective. "For 11 months they enjoyed nice air from Indonesia and they never thanked us," he said. South-East Asians **flocked** to a satirical website created to express gratitude to Indonesia. The site has registered more than 34m votes of sarcastic thanks.

- **brace v.** ~sb/yourself (for sth) to prepare sb/yourself for sth difficult or unpleasant that is going to happen (为困难或坏事) 使作准备；使防备

UN troops are braced for more violence. 联合国部队准备应付更多的暴行。

- **engulf v.** /ɪn'gʌlf/ to surround or to cover sb/sth completely 包围；吞没；淹没

The vehicle was engulfed in flames. 汽车被大火吞没。

- **flock v.** to go or gather together somewhere in large numbers 群集；聚集；蜂拥【考研大纲词汇】

Thousands of people flocked to the beach this weekend. 这个周末有好几千人蜂拥到了海滩。

2015 年，当东南亚地区被印度尼西亚火灾引发的有毒烟雾笼罩时，时任该国副总统的尤苏夫·卡拉表示，邻国们需要转变观念。“整整 11 个月，他们享受着来自印度尼西亚的清新空气，却从未向我们道过谢，”他说。对此，东南亚民众纷纷涌向一个专门用来向印度尼西亚表达感谢的讽刺网站。该网站目前共收到超过 3400 万次带有讽刺意味的“感谢”投票。

【Para.2】

That number may soon grow. Fears of another severe **haze** are rising as fires rage in Indonesia. Weather-watchers estimate that the number of **blazes** detected across the island of Borneo in the first 12 days of August alone exceeds the figure registered during the entire month in each of the past seven years. The smoke is already forcing officials to act. In Pontianak, the capital of the Indonesian province of West Kalimantan, schools have shut. In neighbouring Sarawak, in Malaysia, officials urged people to stay indoors. Singapore has put its own **responders on standby**.

- **haze n.** air containing sth that makes it difficult to see through it (烟尘等的) 雾霭，烟雾

a haze of smoke/dust/steam 烟/尘/蒸汽雾

- **blaze** n. (used especially in newspapers 尤用于报章) a very large fire, especially a dangerous one 烈火；火灾【考研大纲词汇】

Five people died in the blaze. 火灾中有五人丧生。

- **responder** n. 应急响应者
- **on standby** *phrase* ready to do sth immediately if needed or asked 随时可以投入行动；处于待命状态；招之即来

The emergency services were put on standby after a bomb warning. 接到炸弹警报后，各紧急救助部门进入待命状态。

这一数字可能很快会增加。随着印尼境内大火肆虐，人们对再次出现严重烟雾的担忧日益加剧。气象观察员估计，仅 8 月前 12 天，在婆罗洲岛上监测到的火灾数量就超过了过去七年中任何一月的记录。浓烟已经迫使官员们采取行动。在印度尼西亚西加里曼丹省首府坤甸，学校已停课。在邻近的马来西亚沙捞越州，官员们敦促民众留在室内。新加坡也已让本国的应急响应人员进入待命状态。

【Para.3】

Meteorologists fear that much worse is to come. El Niño, a weather pattern associated with unusually warm waters in the Pacific, tends to cause drier conditions in the region. This increases the chance of fires, especially

on Indonesia's peatlands, where the carbon-rich soil is more **combustible** and where fires **smouldering** underground are hard to **extinguish**. Many **climatologists** think that this year's El Niño will turn out to be the strongest yet, raising concerns about a haze **episode** comparable to the one in 2015.

- **meteorologist n.** /ˌmi:tɪəˈrɒlədʒɪst/ a scientist who studies meteorology 气象学家

- **combustible a.** /kəmˈbʌstəbl/ able to begin burning easily 易燃的；可燃的

SYN flammable

combustible material/gases 易燃材料/气体

- **smoulder v.** /ˈsməʊldə(r)/ to burn slowly without a flame (无明火地) 阴燃，闷燃

The bonfire was still smouldering the next day. 到了第二天，篝火还在闷燃。

- **extinguish v.** /ɪkˈstɪŋɡwɪʃ/ to make a fire stop burning or a light stop shining 熄灭；扑灭【考研大纲词汇】

SYN put out

Firefighters tried to extinguish the flames. 消防队员奋力救火。

- **climatologist n.** /ˌklaɪməˈtɒlədʒɪst/ A climatologist is someone who studies climates. 气象学家

- **episode n.** You can refer to an event or a short period of time as an episode if you want to suggest that it is

important or unusual, or has some particular quality. 事件;

经历【考研大纲词汇】

This episode is bound to be a deep embarrassment for Washington. 这一事件必然使华盛顿大为尴尬。

但气象学家担心情况会变得更糟。厄尔尼诺现象是一种与太平洋海域异常暖水相关的气象现象，往往会导致该地区气候更加干燥。这其实提高了火灾风险，特别是在印尼的泥炭地上——那里土壤富含碳，更易燃烧，且地下阴燃的火势难以扑灭。许多气候学家认为，今年的厄尔尼诺现象将成为有史以来最强的一次，这引发了人们对可能出现与2015年相当的烟霾事件的担忧。

【Para.4】

That would be a disaster. The **smog** in 2015 caused some 100,000 excess deaths in Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore, according to one study. But there was also a heavy economic **toll**: the World Bank put Indonesia's losses at \$16.1bn, almost 2% of GDP. Economies in the region are already **vulnerable**, having been hit to varying degrees by the war in Iran.

- **smog n.** Smog is a mixture of fog and smoke which occurs in some busy industrial cities. 烟雾【考研大纲词汇】

Cars cause pollution, both smog and acid rain. 汽车引起污染，既有烟雾又有酸雨。

- **toll** n. the amount of damage or the number of deaths and injuries that are caused in a particular war, disaster, etc. (战争、灾难等造成的) 毁坏；伤亡人数【考研大纲词汇】

The official death toll has now reached 7 000. 官方公布的死亡人数现已达 7 000 人。

- **vulnerable** a. /'vʌlnərəbl/ ~ (to sb/sth) weak and easily hurt physically or emotionally (身体上或感情上) 脆弱的，易受...伤害的【考研大纲词汇】

The sudden resignation of the financial director put the company in a very vulnerable position. 财务部主任的突然辞职使得这家公司岌岌可危。

如若发生，那将是一场灾难。据一项研究显示，2015 年的烟雾在印度尼西亚、马来西亚和新加坡导致约 10 万人的超额死亡。此外，经济损失也十分惨重：世界银行估算印度尼西亚的损失达 161 亿美元，几乎占其国内生产总值（GDP）的 2%。该地区各国经济本就脆弱，且已因伊朗战争而受到不同程度的冲击。

【Para.5】

That war could also contribute to the haze. The **blockade** of the Strait of Hormuz has pushed up fuel and fertiliser costs, prompting the Indonesian government to **mandate** greater use of biofuels. This, in turn,

is driving up the demand for palm oil, putting pressure on farmers and plantation companies to clear more land with fire.

- **blockade** n. /blɒ'keɪd/ a barrier that stops people or vehicles from entering or leaving a place 障碍物；屏障

The police set up blockades on highways leading out of the city. 警察在城市出口的公路上设下路障。

- **mandate** v. /'mændeɪt/ To mandate something means to make it mandatory. 强制执行

The proposed initiative would mandate a reduction of carbon dioxide of 40%. 这个倡议将把二氧化碳排放量强制降低40%。

伊朗战争也可能加剧烟霾。霍尔木兹海峡的封锁推高了燃料和化肥成本，促使印尼政府强制要求增加生物燃料的使用。这反过来又推高了棕榈油的需求，迫使农民和种植园公司通过焚烧开垦更多土地。

【Para.6】

The region may be better prepared than it was a decade ago. Better satellite monitoring has improved forecasts. A centre in Singapore tracks fires and smoke across the region and provides early warnings, allowing governments to implement public-health measures. In April ASEAN, the regional bloc, **inaugurated** the secretariat of a new haze-control centre in

Jakarta, Indonesia's capital, which seeks to improve co-ordination between governments.

- **inaugurate** v. /ɪn'ɔ:ɡjʊ'reɪt/ When a new building or institution is inaugurated, it is declared open in a formal ceremony. 为...举行开幕式; 为...举行落成典礼【考研大纲词汇】
A Mafia Museum was inaugurated in Corleone. 一座黑手党博物馆在科莱奥内举行落成典礼。

与十年前相比，该地区的准备也许完善了一些。更先进的卫星监测技术提高了预报精度。新加坡的一个中心负责追踪整个地区的火灾和烟雾情况并发布预警，使各国政府能够及时采取公共卫生措施。今年 4 月，区域组织东盟在印度尼西亚首都雅加达为新成立的烟霾控制中心秘书处举行了揭牌仪式，该中心旨在加强各国政府之间的协调配合。

【Para.7】

But for all the machinery of regional co-operation, it still lacks much bite. ASEAN has had an agreement on **transboundary** haze since 2002, but implementation and enforcement rest with national governments. Its fund to pay for anti-haze resources, such as water-bombing aircraft and other firefighting equipment, relies on **voluntary** contributions and remains small.

- **bite** n. [U] a quality that makes sth effective or powerful 影

响力；感染力【考研大纲词汇】

The performance had no bite to it. 这次演出毫无感染力。

- **transboundary** a. 跨界
- **voluntary** a. done willingly, not because you are forced 自愿的；志愿的；主动的；自告奋勇的【考研大纲词汇】

to pay voluntary contributions into a pension fund 自愿向退休基金交款

尽管该地区建立了完善的区域合作机制，但其约束力仍显不足。东盟自 2002 年起便签署了关于跨境烟霾的协议，但具体实施和执行仍由各国政府负责。该组织用于支付抗烟霾资源（如水轰炸机和其他消防设备）的基金依赖于自愿捐款，规模依然有限。

【Para.8】

Ultimately, the severity of haze-related problems this year will depend on what happens in Indonesia. After the disaster of 2015, Joko Widodo, then the president, made prevention a **priority**. His successor, Prabowo Subianto, has kept much of that emphasis. Last year he created a new department to tackle blazes, and strengthened **patrols**, aerial **surveillance** and emergency teams. In the coming weeks, they face trial by fire.

- **priority** n. something that you think is more important than other things and should be dealt with first 优先事项；最重要

的事；首要事情【考研大纲词汇】

Education is a top priority. 教育是当务之急。

- **patrol** n. /pə'trəʊl/ the act of going to different parts of a building, an area, etc. to make sure that there is no trouble or crime 巡逻；巡查【考研大纲词汇】

Security guards make regular patrols at night. 夜间保安人员定时巡逻。

- **surveillance** n. /sɜ:'veɪləns/ [U] the act of carefully watching a person suspected of a crime or a place where a crime may be committed (对犯罪嫌疑人或可能发生犯罪的地方的) 监视
SYN observation

The police are keeping the suspects under constant surveillance. 警方正对嫌疑人实施不间断监视。

归根结底，今年烟霾问题的严重程度将取决于印尼局势的发展。2015 年灾难发生后，时任总统佐科·维多多将预防工作列为优先事项。他的继任者普拉博沃·苏比安托在很大程度上延续了这一重点。去年，苏比安托还设立了一个新部门专门负责应对火灾，并加强了巡逻、空中监控和应急队伍。而在未来几周内，他们将面临严峻考验。

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➤ 今日翻译作业

(Para. 3) This increases the chance of fires, especially on Indonesia's peatlands, where the carbon rich soil is more combustible and where fires smouldering underground are hard to extinguish.

（下一页提供句子分析）

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 3. This increases the chance of fires, especially on Indonesia' s peatlands, where the carbon rich soil is more combustible and where fires smouldering underground are hard to extinguish. 这其实提高了火灾风险，特别是在印尼的泥炭地上——那里土壤富含碳，更易燃烧，且地下阴燃的火势难以扑灭。

主句

This increases the chance of fires,

主语 谓语 宾语

especially on Indonesia' s peatlands,

状语

定语从句 1

where the carbon rich soil is more combustible and

(引导词) 从句主语 系语 表语 (并列连词)

定语从句 2

where fires smouldering underground are

(引导词) 从句主语 定语 系语

hard to extinguish.

表语

句子分析：

主句：

主 语-This； 谓 语-increases； 宾 语-the chance of fires
(chance n. 可能性； 几率， the chance of fires 火灾风险)；

地点状语-especially on Indonesia' s peatlands；

定语从句 1， 修饰 Indonesia' s peatlands：

(引导词) -where； 主语-the carbon rich soil (这里表达的是当地的土壤就富含碳)； 系语-is； 表语-more combustible；
(并列连词) -and；

定语从句 2：

(引导词) -where； 主语-fires (这里 fire 是复数形式， 是为了表示 “多次的火灾”)； 定语-smouldering underground (smoulder 强调 “缓慢的闷烧或阴烧”)； 系语-are； 表语-hard to extinguish.

➤ 写作积累

Para.3 Meteorologists fear that much worse **is to come**

be to come 意为“注定会发生”，这里整句可以理解为“气象学家担心，更糟糕的情况还在后头。”作为开头，这句话很好地起到了承上启下的作用，上一段提到8月的火灾引发的浓烟，这一段提到厄尔尼诺现象可能会导致的加强效应，所以这里很自然地用 much worse 去铺垫。

相较于 will come 这个较为中性的表达，be to come 会突出“必然发生”的紧迫感，且相对正式一点，例如：The president is to visit Japan next month. 总统预定下月访日。

Para.7 But **for all** the machinery of regional co-operation, it still lacks much **bite**.

for all+ 名词短语，一般在句首时，会用来引导让步状语，表示“尽管；即便有”，例句：For all its clarity of style, the book is not easy reading. 这本书虽然文体清晰，但读起来并不容易。因此原文选句这里指“尽管该地区建立了完善的区域合作机制，……”

For all his wealth, he is not happy. 尽管他很有钱，但他并不快乐。

另，虽然这里的 bite 在翻译时一般会处理为“影响力”，但它实际上常会搭配法律法规或者协议使用，强调政策等“有实效；有约束力”。

有类似隐喻的表达还包括：toothless a. “无牙的” ㄣ (官方组织或法律) 无权威的【联系记忆：toothless 就无法 bite】

In his view, the commission remains a toothless and ineffectual body. 在他看来，委员会仍然是个没有权威而且缺乏效率的机构。